

MERIDIAN TECHNOLOGIES PVT. LTD.

Internal Policy Document

Travel Reimbursement Policy

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1. Purpose and Applicability

Objective

This policy defines rules for business travel undertaken by employees of Meridian Technologies, both domestic and international. It applies to all confirmed employees and pre-approved contract staff travelling on behalf of the company.

The policy aims to ensure that business travel is undertaken in a manner that is safe, cost effective, and consistent with the company's values around prudence and accountability.

Scope and Exclusions

Personal travel using corporate channels, leisure extensions to business trips, and travel by family members accompanying the employee are explicitly outside the scope of company reimbursement.

Where a business trip is extended for personal reasons, the incremental cost is borne entirely by the employee and clearly segregated in the expense claim.

Policy Owner

The Travel Desk under Admin Services is the operational owner of this policy. Finance owns the reimbursement workflow and audit aspects.

2. Travel Authorisation

Pre-Approval

All business travel must be pre-approved by the Reporting Manager and Business Unit Head. International travel additionally requires approval from the Travel Desk and the relevant VP.

Approval must be obtained before any bookings are made. Travel undertaken without prior approval is not reimbursable, except in genuine emergencies subject to post-facto ratification.

Travel Requisition

Travel Requisition Form (TRF-01) must be submitted at least 7 working days in advance for domestic and 15 working days in advance for international travel.

The TRF must include the business purpose, itinerary, estimated cost, and the funding cost centre. Incomplete TRFs are returned by the Travel Desk and may delay bookings.

3. Domestic Travel

Air Travel

Domestic air travel is permitted in economy class for all bands. Senior Vice Presidents and above are entitled to business class on flights longer than 2 hours.

Bookings must be made through the empanelled travel agent or the online travel portal. Direct purchase from airlines is reimbursable only with prior written approval.

Employees are expected to book at least 5 working days in advance to benefit from advance purchase fares. Same day bookings require justification in the TRF.

Rail Travel

Rail travel is permitted in AC 2-tier for managers and below, and AC 1-tier for AVP and above. Tatkal charges are reimbursable only if travel was urgent and approved.

Auto-upgrades by the Indian Railways system are reimbursable on actuals against the upgrade receipt.

Road Travel

Inter-city road travel by company-arranged cab or self-driven vehicle is reimbursable based on the Local Conveyance section. Sleeper class private bus travel is permitted only where rail and air are not feasible.

4. International Travel***Class of Travel***

Economy class for journeys up to 6 hours. Premium economy is permitted for journeys 6 to 10 hours for managers and above. Business class is permitted for journeys exceeding 10 hours for AVP and above.

Journey duration is measured as total flight time excluding layovers. Layovers exceeding 4 hours may attract eligibility for an upgrade with prior VP approval.

Documentation

Valid passport (minimum 6 months validity), visa, travel insurance, and an approved TRF must be in place before booking. Visa fees and travel insurance are fully reimbursable.

Photocopies of passport, visa, and insurance must be uploaded to the HRMS travel module before departure. The employee is responsible for ensuring compliance with the host country's entry requirements.

Vaccinations and Health

Mandatory vaccinations and health screenings for travel to specific countries are reimbursed against medical receipts. The Travel Desk maintains an up-to-date country-wise requirements matrix.

5. Accommodation and Class Entitlements***Domestic Accommodation Ceilings (per night, excluding taxes)***

Tier 1 cities (Bengaluru, Mumbai, Delhi NCR, Chennai, Hyderabad, Pune, Kolkata): Rs. 6,000 (managers and below), Rs. 8,500 (AVP and above).

Tier 2 cities: Rs. 4,500 and Rs. 6,000 respectively.

Tier 3 cities and others: Rs. 3,500 and Rs. 4,500 respectively.

International Accommodation Ceilings (per night, USD)

USA, UK, Western Europe, Singapore, Japan: USD 200 (managers and below), USD 275 (AVP and above).

Other regions: USD 150 and USD 200 respectively.

Ceilings are exclusive of local taxes and resort fees, both of which are reimbursable on actuals against tax invoices.

Hotel Selection Guidelines

Where possible, employees must book through the empanelled hotel chain partners to leverage negotiated corporate rates. Booking outside this list requires justification and may be capped at the negotiated rate.

Room categories above the standard category are not reimbursable unless the standard category is unavailable, documented through a non-availability note from the hotel.

6. Per Diem Allowance

Domestic Per Diem

Domestic per diem: Rs. 1,500 per day inclusive of meals, laundry, and local incidentals. Per diem is paid for each completed 24 hour period away from base location, with a 50 percent rate for any incomplete day beyond 6 hours.

Per diem is not payable for days where the company is directly bearing the full cost of meals (for example, client-hosted full-day events with all meals provided).

International Per Diem

International per diem: USD 75 per day for travel to USA, UK, Western Europe, Singapore, Japan. USD 60 per day for other countries. Per diem is paid in INR equivalent at the rate prevailing on the date of disbursement.

Where a single trip covers multiple countries, the per diem rate of each country applies for the days spent in that country, computed on a calendar-day basis.

Coverage and Documentation

Per diem is in addition to actual accommodation reimbursement and covers meals, laundry, tips, and incidental expenses. No separate meal bills are required to be submitted.

Employees are still required to maintain a brief log of business activity for each day claimed, available for sample audit by Finance.

7. Local Conveyance

Cab Usage

Airport transfers within the same city by app-based cabs (Uber, Ola) are reimbursable on actuals. Outstation cab usage requires prior approval.

Cab class is restricted to non-premium categories (Mini, Sedan) unless a premium class is operationally necessary due to passenger or baggage requirements.

Personal Vehicle Usage

Personal vehicle usage for business travel is reimbursed at Rs. 12 per km for cars and Rs. 5 per km for two-wheelers, supported by a log entry.

Toll and parking charges incurred during business travel by personal vehicle are reimbursable separately against original receipts.

8. Reimbursement Procedure

Submission Window

All travel expense claims must be submitted in the HRMS travel module within 15 working days of completion of travel, with original receipts attached as scans.

Receipts must be legible, original, and in the name of the employee where applicable. Hand-written acknowledgements are accepted only below the de minimis threshold defined in the Expense Policy.

Approval and Payment Flow

Claims submitted beyond 30 working days will be rejected. Approval flow: Reporting Manager -> Finance for validation -> Payroll for payment with next salary cycle.

Finance may request additional clarification or documentation, in which case the claim is held in queue until the employee responds. Repeated incomplete claims may attract corrective coaching.

9. Forex and Card Policy

Forex Drawal

Forex is to be drawn through the empanelled forex partner. The maximum forex advance is 80 percent of expected international expenses excluding accommodation if paid by company card.

Forex card top-ups during the trip are permitted in case of unforeseen expenses, subject to a written request to the Travel Desk and post-trip reconciliation.

Corporate Cards

Corporate credit cards are issued to eligible roles (AVP and above) for travel expenses. Personal expenses on corporate cards are strictly prohibited.

Card statements are reconciled monthly with submitted expense claims. Any unreconciled balance after 60 days is recovered from payroll.

10. Violations and Disciplinary Action

Fraudulent Claims

Any claim found to be inflated, fabricated, or otherwise in breach of this policy will be subject to disciplinary action under the Code of Conduct, up to and including termination of employment.

Where fraud is established, the amount in question is recovered in full from the employee and may attract criminal proceedings depending on the magnitude.

Procedural Lapses

Repeated late submissions may result in suspension of travel privileges for up to 6 months.

Failure to submit settlement against advance within the stipulated window may attract recovery of the entire advance from payroll along with applicable taxes.